

Other confusing words

MISSPELLED WORDS OFTEN ARISE FROM CONFUSED MEANINGS.

Some words are misunderstood and therefore spelled incorrectly. Choosing the wrong word can alter the meaning of a sentence, which may confuse the reader.

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Confused meanings

Some words are incorrectly spelled because their meanings are not properly understood. In some cases, two words may sound similar, which only adds to the confusion.

With such words, the difference in meaning and spelling has to be learned; there is no trick or rule to remember. Consult a dictionary if in doubt about which word to use.

adapt

This refers to making something suitable.

or

adopt

This can mean to follow an idea or method.

A fish can **adapt** to a new habitat.

They will **adopt** the new policy.

conscience

This refers to a sense of right or wrong.

or

conscious

This means to be aware or awake.

Her **conscience** told her to confess.

He was **conscious** of his faults.

disinterested

This refers to an impartial person.

or

uninterested

This means having no interest.

The **disinterested** reporter is talking.

He is **uninterested** in the show.

distinct

This refers to something that is different.

or

distinctive

This means a feature of a person or thing.

There are two **distinct** cell types.

She had a **distinctive** voice.

historic

This refers to something famous in history.

or

historical

This means something linked to the past.

The moon landing is a **historic** event.

The museum held **historical** relics.

regretful

This refers to the feeling of regret.

or

regrettable

This means to give rise to regret.

She was **regretful** for her actions.

The loss of jobs was **regrettable**.